AI and the labour market

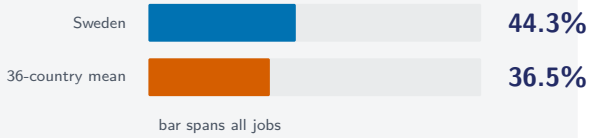
What the evidence shows, internationally and for Sweden in depth

This page describes; it does not explain. Everything here is measured, but none of it shows that AI *caused* what you are looking at. Other things moved over the same years: interest rates, a pandemic, the ordinary business cycle. **Read the dates, not the sheet's date:** the sheet is generated on demand, the evidence is not, and every figure carries its own vintage.

FOUR QUESTIONS, MEASURED SEPARATELY

Sweden · international comparison

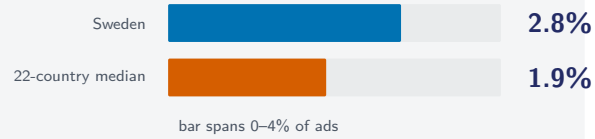
How exposed are jobs to AI?



Jobs in the most AI-exposed quarter of occupations. Exposure describes applicability, not who loses work.

Source: DAIOE generative-AI composite (g2gen) v2025 · EU-LFS 2025

How often do employers ask for AI skills?



Advertisements asking for an AI skill: a small part of hiring. The Swedish series in the figure below is stricter and reads lower.

Source: AI Index / Lightcast · 2025

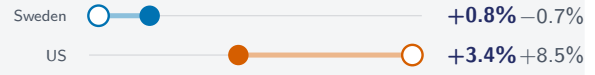
How many firms use AI?



Firms with 10 or more persons employed, 2025; the tick marks the 2024 wave. Smaller firms are not in this survey.

Source: Eurostat · 2025

What has happened to pay?

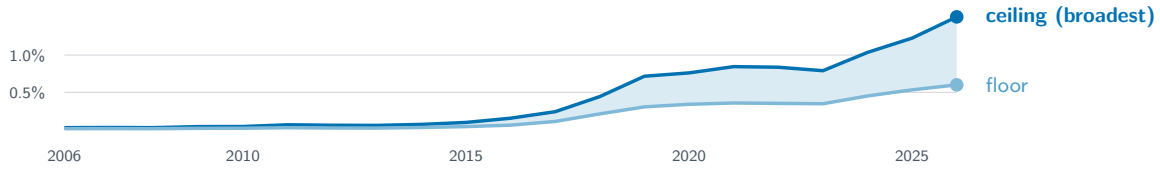


Real wage growth by exposure, most exposed in bold. No Swedish gap; the US gap runs the other way.

Source: SCB · BLS OEWS × DAIOE g2gen v2025 · real terms · SE 2014–2025, US 2015–2025

SWEDEN IN DEPTH: HOW OFTEN DO JOB ADS ASK FOR AI?

Every advertisement on the public job board



A **range**, not a single number: the floor counts an advertisement only when an AI skill is asked of the person hired; the ceiling adds AI terms anywhere and the hand-read share of ads that only say "AI". Ads naming an AI term went from 0.03% of advertisements in the pooled 2006–2008 base to 1.05% in 2025, about 40 times as high, and the 2025 range is **0.53% to 1.23%**. Both lines rest on a term list and cover only the AI demand that words reveal.

Right now (19 Oct 2026): of the 36,696 most recent advertisements, 1.38% name an AI term and 0.77% ask for one in the job itself. This is the only figure on the sheet that moves daily.

JobTech / Platsbanken job ads (CC0), frozen v1.7 term list, distinct advertisements

How capable are AI systems?

12–17h

at 50% success

the longest human-expert tasks frontier AI agents complete; the length has been doubling every 4–6 months. This is the technology the four questions are read against, not a fifth question about the labour market.

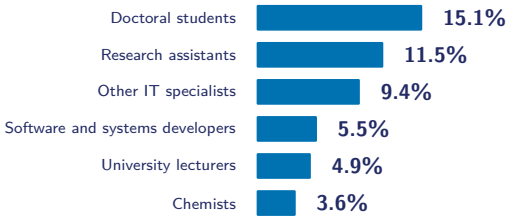
METR · May 2026

Before you quote this. The Swedish series counts what employers *write down when hiring*: not jobs, and not firms using AI, two of the panels above. Not all hiring is advertised. A rising line means only that employers ask for AI skills more often.

WHERE THE DEMAND ACTUALLY SITS

Swedish occupations, 2025, ranked by the share of their advertisements asking for AI

Asks most often



And in none of these

0.0% Registered nurses (15,842 ads)

0.0% Personal care assistants (14,946 ads)

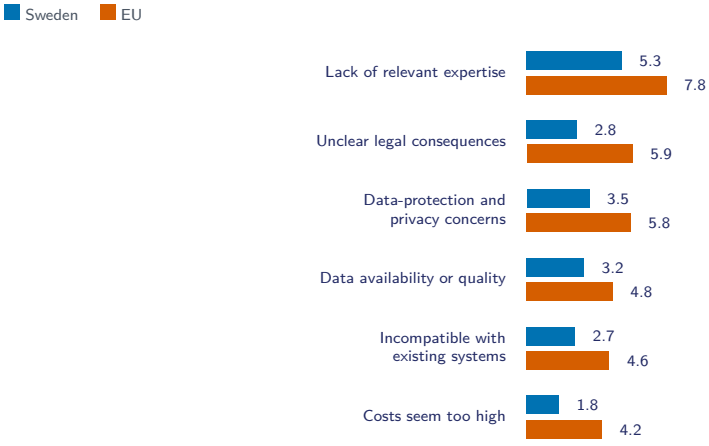
0.0% Assistant nurses, home care etc. (8,607 ads)

These are among the largest occupations on the board. The demand is real and it is concentrated: most of the labour market is not being asked for AI at all.

JobTech / Platsbanken job ads (CC0), frozen v1.7 term list, distinct advertisements

OBSTACLES FIRMS NAME

Per cent of all firms with 10+ persons employed, 2025



Shares are of every firm in the survey, not of non-adopters, so they do not sum to anything. Sweden is below the EU on every barrier, which is partly mechanical: the more firms already use AI, the fewer are left to be asked why they do not. Not comparable with 2021: Eurostat flags a break in the Swedish series.

IN THE EMPLOYERS' OWN WORDS

Advertisement headlines, as written

Most common: 2026 · H1 Machine learning engineer · Data scientist

New titles appearing

AI ambassador (2023) · AI content producer (2023) · AI-experter / AI experts (2024) · AI lead (2025) · AI data annotation specialist (2025) · Senior agentic AI developer (2026)

Titles that stopped clearing the bar

Telemarketer (2018) · Construction engineer (2022) · Mathematical statistician (2023) · Inside sales (2024) · Network technician (2024)

One entry is a measurement artefact worth naming: medical secretary (medicinsk sekreterare) appears because those advertisements mention speech-recognition software, which our classifier judges to be a tool the job uses rather than an AI skill it asks for.

WHAT THIS CANNOT SEE

No task-level data. We see what employers write in advertisements, not how work is actually done, nor how tasks and responsibilities shift inside a job that keeps its name.

Not all hiring is advertised. This is the advertised margin. Occupations that hire through networks or internal moves are under-represented, and that varies by sector.

One job board. Platsbanken is large and stable but it is not the whole market, and its reach has fallen somewhat relative to surveyed vacancies since 2006.

Validated on one year. Precision and recall are measured on 2024 advertisements. An early-period check covering 2006 to 2013 is drawn and not yet done.

Exposure is not displacement. The exposure measure on page one describes tasks AI could affect. It is not a prediction that anyone loses work.

AISCAF WASP—HS Hard to read? Every figure is on the web page as selectable text at any zoom, with the numbers as CSV: ai-econlab.com/monitor. AI-Econ Lab, Örebro University and the Ratio Institute. Örebro University is one of the three nodes of AISCAF, a research cluster financed by WASP-HS, which funds part of the lab's team. Public data throughout; every figure is reproducible from the source beside it. Method: ai-econlab.com/monitor/methods.